The Greedy Merchant's Lesson

In a bustling village nestled between rolling hills, there lived a merchant named Jafar. Known far and wide for his vast collection of treasures, Jafar was admired by many but envied by just as many. His shop was filled with shining jewels, golden coins, and fine silks from distant lands. Yet, despite his riches, Jafar was never satisfied. He always wanted more.

One day, a mysterious old man visited Jafar’s shop. He carried a small, plain box and said, "Inside this box is a magic seed. Plant it, water it, and it will grow into a tree that bears gold coins."

Jafar’s eyes sparkled with greed. Without hesitation, he bought the seed for a hefty price and rushed home. He planted the seed in his garden and waited eagerly. Days passed, and a small sprout appeared.
Soon, the sprout turned into a tree with golden leaves and shimmering fruits that looked like coins.

Every day, Jafar picked the golden coins from the tree, counting them endlessly. His greed grew stronger as did his desire for more coins. He stopped caring for his customers, his friends, and even his family.
All he wanted was to gather as many golden coins as possible.

One night, a fierce storm battered the village. Lightning struck Jafar’s garden and the golden tree was destroyed. When dawn broke, Jafar found his once-glorious tree reduced to ashes. He realized that in his greed, he had ignored everything else important in life.

With no magical tree and no friends left, Jafar felt emptier than ever. He decided to change his ways. He started helping his neighbors, shared his remaining treasures, and worked hard to rebuild his shop.
Slowly, the villagers returned, and Jafar found joy in generosity and kindness rather than in gold.

From that day forward, Jafar understood that greed only brings destruction, but sharing and caring bring true wealth and happiness.

The lesson: Greed may promise riches, but it often leads to loss and loneliness. True happiness comes from generosity, balance, and valuing the people around us.